

Lost & Found

UX/UI · PERSONAL PROJECT



What if lost and found reports could find each other first?

[Overview]

Lost & Found is a concept for privately matching lost and found reports instead of publishing them for everyone to browse. Users describe what they lost or found, and the system compares details such as the item, description, photos, location and date before connecting potential matches through a private chat.

Role

Product Designer · UX/UI & product logic

Team

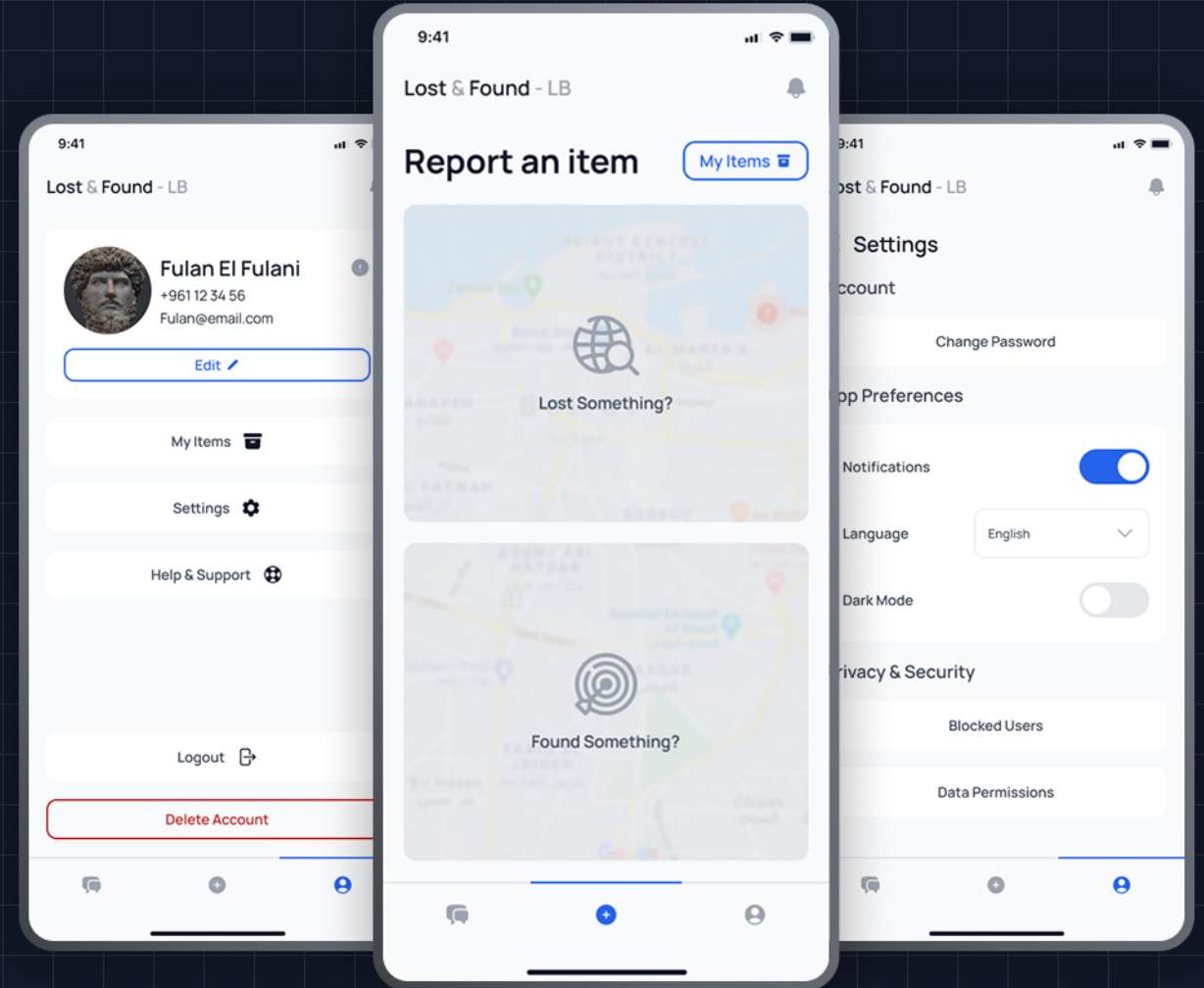
1 Designer · 2 Developers

Project

Personal Concept

Status

UX/UI completed · Development unfinished



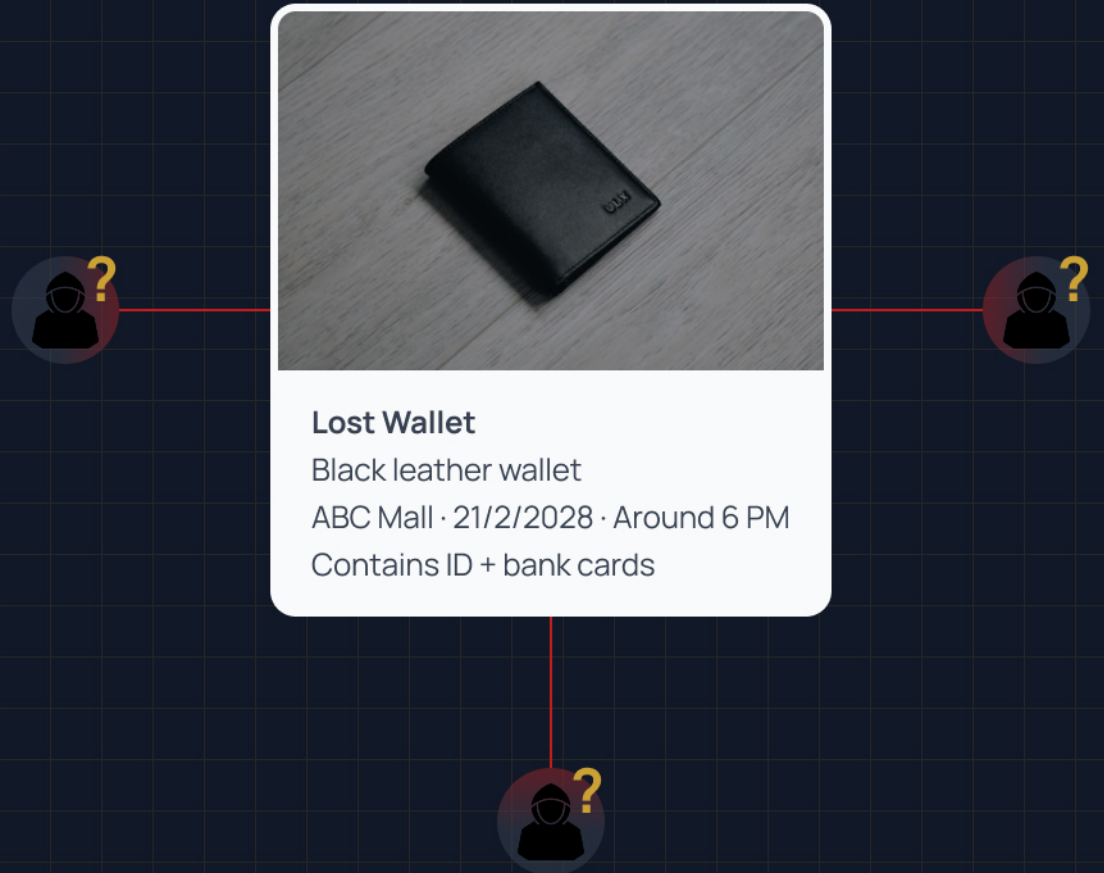
Public lost-and-found posts can reveal too much.

[Problem Framing]

Traditional lost-and-found posts rely on publicly sharing enough information for someone to recognize an item. But the same details can also help someone falsely claim it.

We wanted a way for lost and found reports to identify each other without exposing every report publicly.

The information needed to identify the item is also the information that can be exploited.



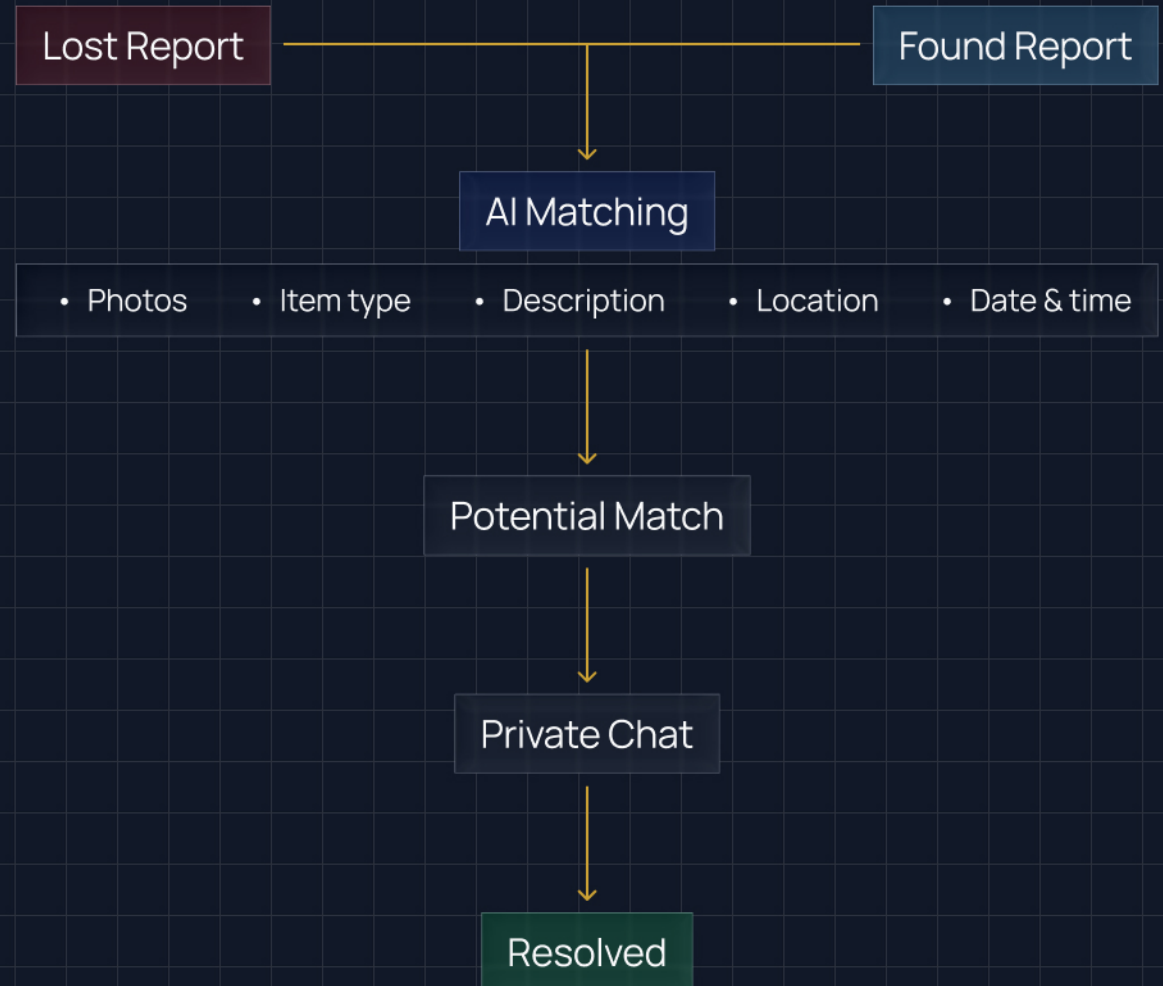
Anyone can see the same identifying details.

Instead of browsing public listings, users are matched privately.

[Product Strategy · Define]

Lost and found reports are kept private rather than published for everyone to browse.

The system compares report details and only connects users when it identifies a potential match.



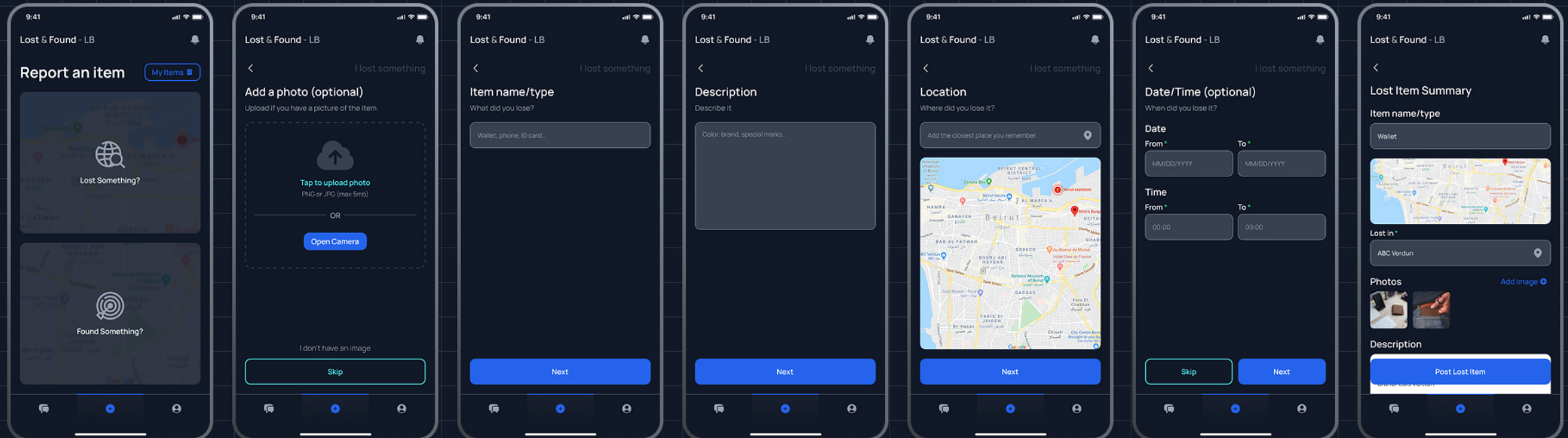
No public item listings

Lost or found, users follow the same reporting flow.

[UX Design]

Both lost and found reports follow the same sequence, collecting the information the matching system needs: a photo, item type, description, location, date and time, followed by a final review.

For lost items, adding a photo is optional because the owner may not have one available. Date and time remain optional in both flows when the exact moment is unknown.

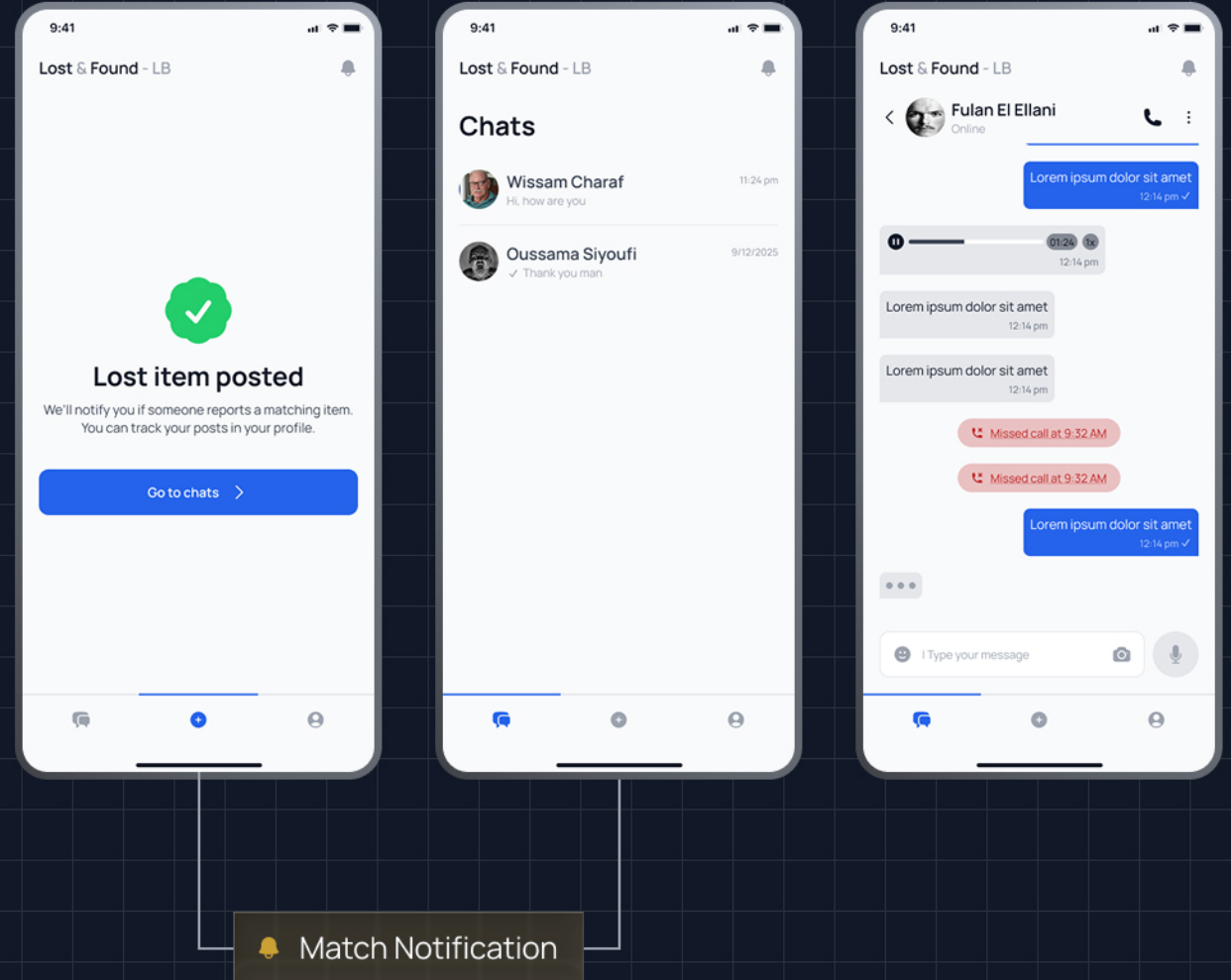


A potential match automatically opens a private conversation.

[Interaction Design]

After a report is posted, matching happens in the background. If the system identifies a potential match, both users receive a notification and a new conversation appears in their chat list.

Users can then confirm the match themselves and arrange the return without exposing their reports publicly.



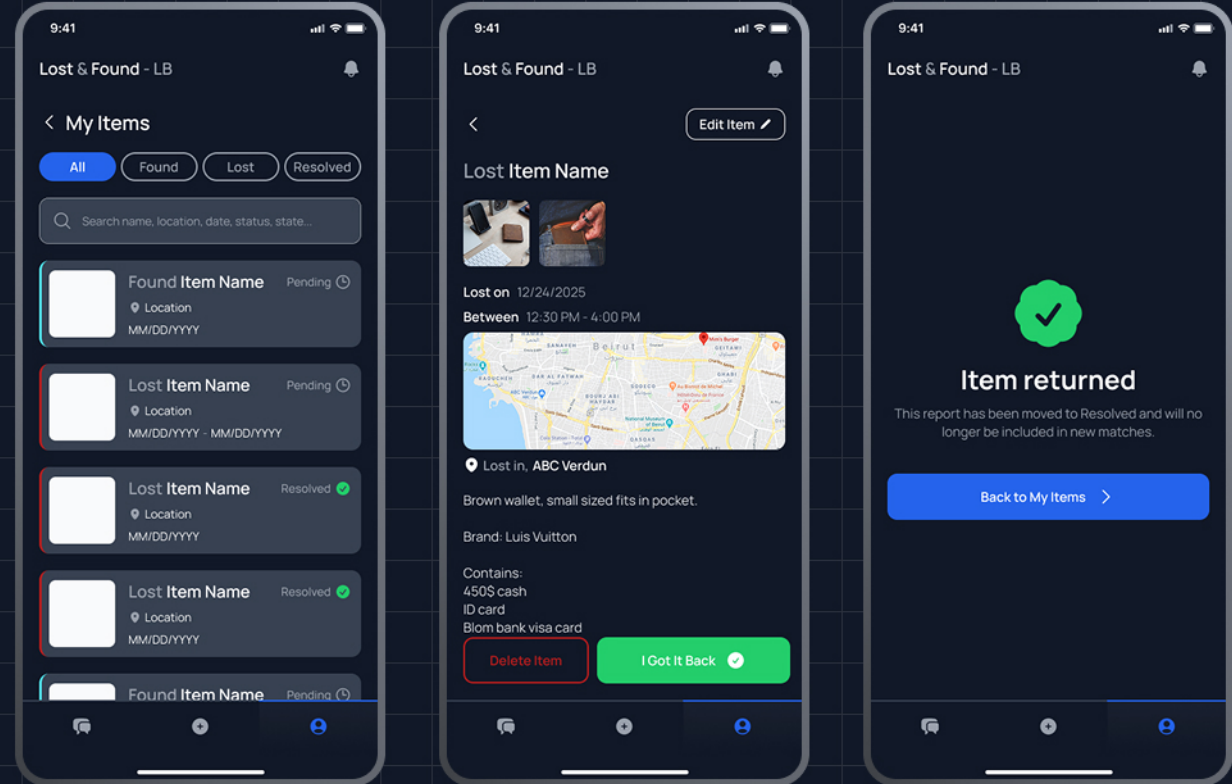
Users can't message each other before the system connects their reports.

Reports stay manageable after they're posted.

[Information Architecture]

My Items gives users one place to track their lost, found and resolved reports.

They can search through previous reports, review their details, edit or delete them, and mark an item as returned once the situation is resolved.



Returned reports move to Resolved and are excluded from future matches.

What I learned, and what I'd test next

[Reflection]

I designed the core product logic, UX/UI, reusable component system, and both light and dark themes. Development started with two developer friends, but the product was never completed or tested in real use.

One rule shaped the whole experience

Keeping reports private and connecting users only after a potential match gave the product a clear direction, from the information collected in each report to when communication becomes available.

The matching experience needs real validation

If I continued the project, I would prototype and test how matches are identified, communicated, and confirmed, including inaccurate matches and uncertain report details, before expanding the product further.

A focused core experience mattered more than expanding the product before its main interaction was validated.